#NoMeetings

Work with fewer and more efficient meetings
in a distributed async teams world



by Javier Rubio

@jrubr /javi-rubio

nomeetings.work

#NoMeetings

Before we start.

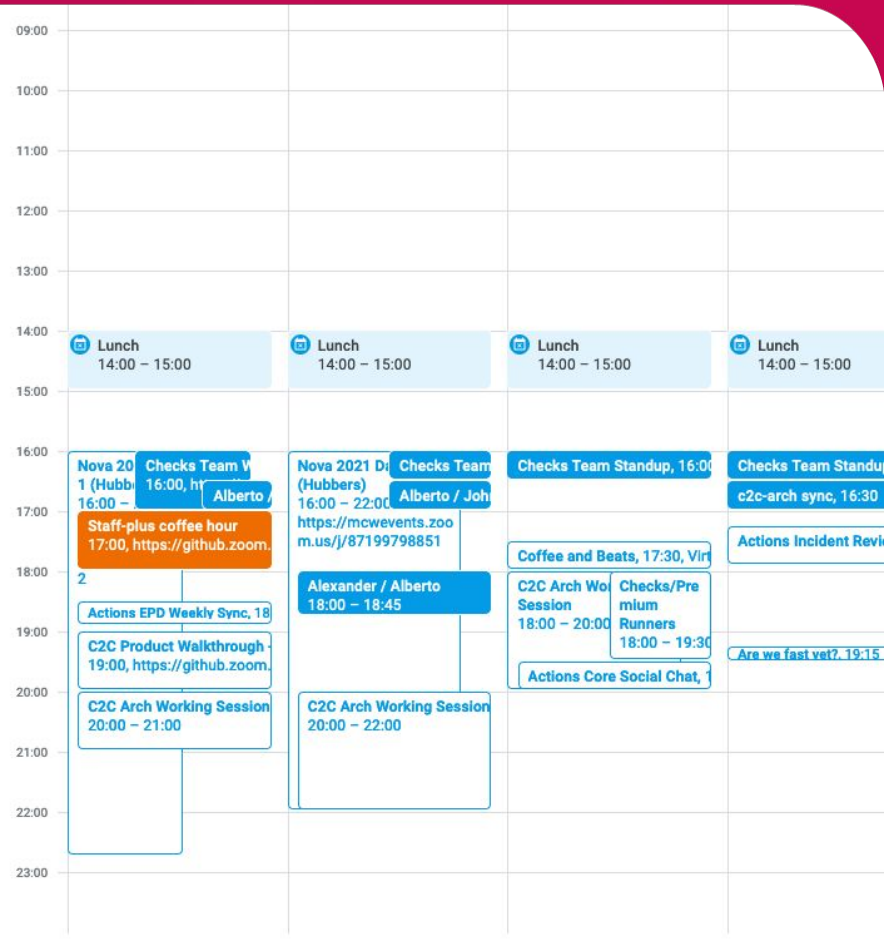
Is this a meeting?

Sync time
2+ people

The meeting's struggle

Too many meetings
Ineffective meetings

Frustration
Unproductive feeling
“When do I work?”



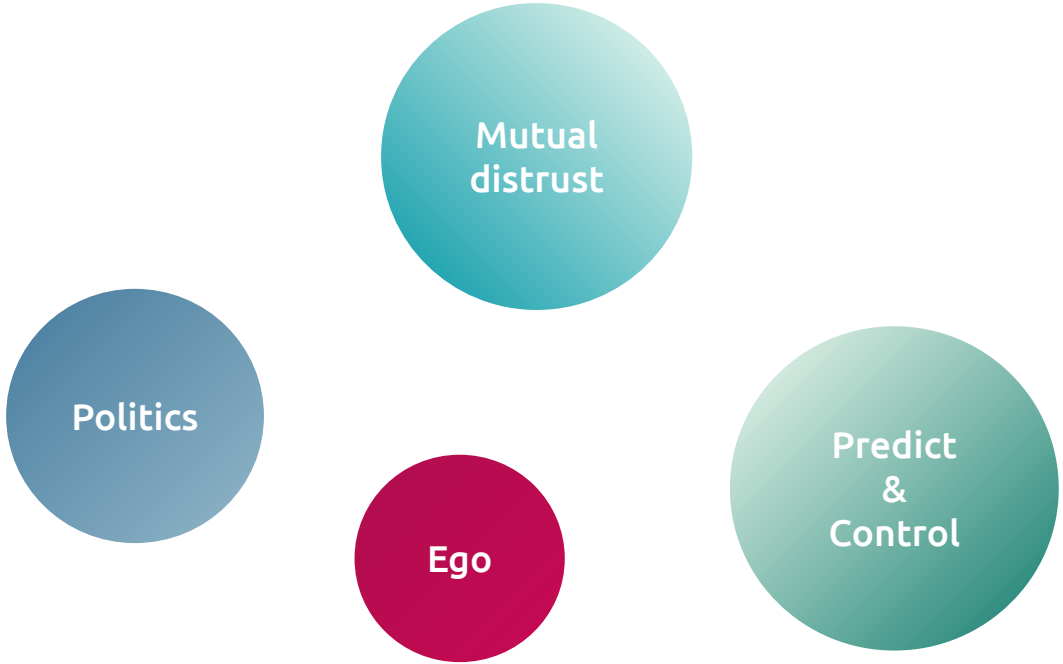
State of the art

Before	⇒	No agenda or objectives ⇒ **#NoMeetings**
	⇒	Strict timeboxing
	⇒	Mindful of trade-offs: who should attend?
During	⇒	Focus & respect
	⇒	Meeting notes / minutes
After	⇒	Follow-up

Why?

Organization's culture

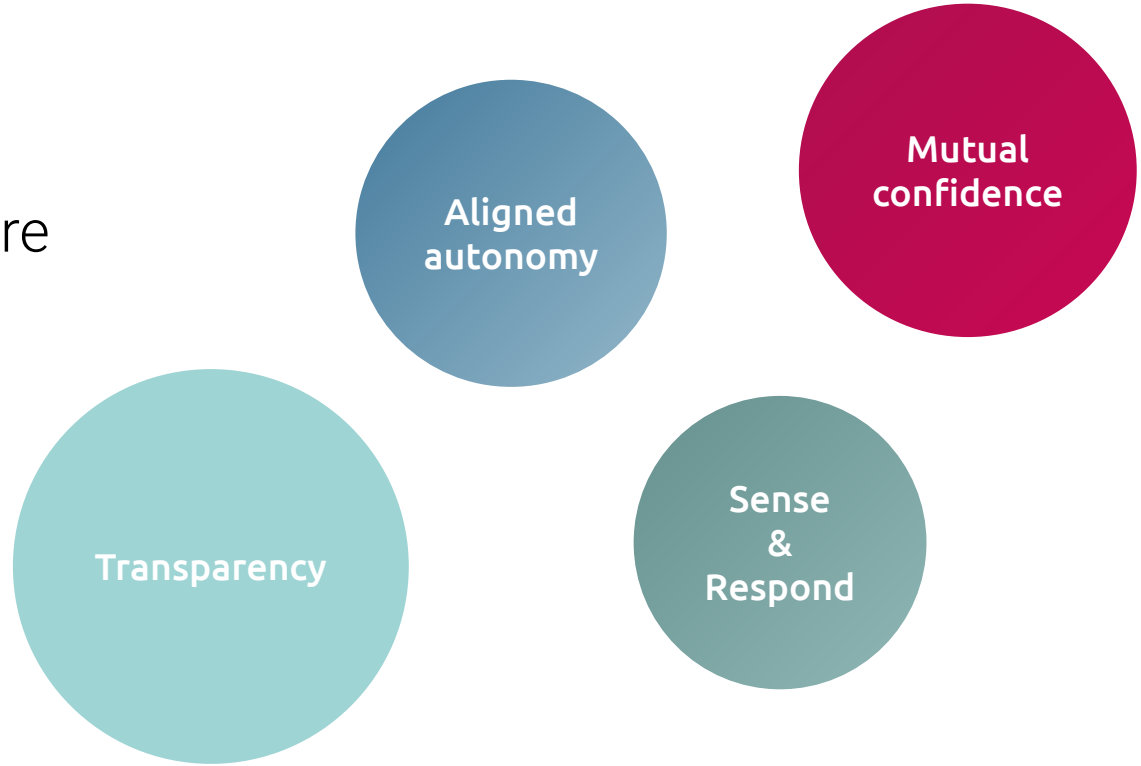
Constraints



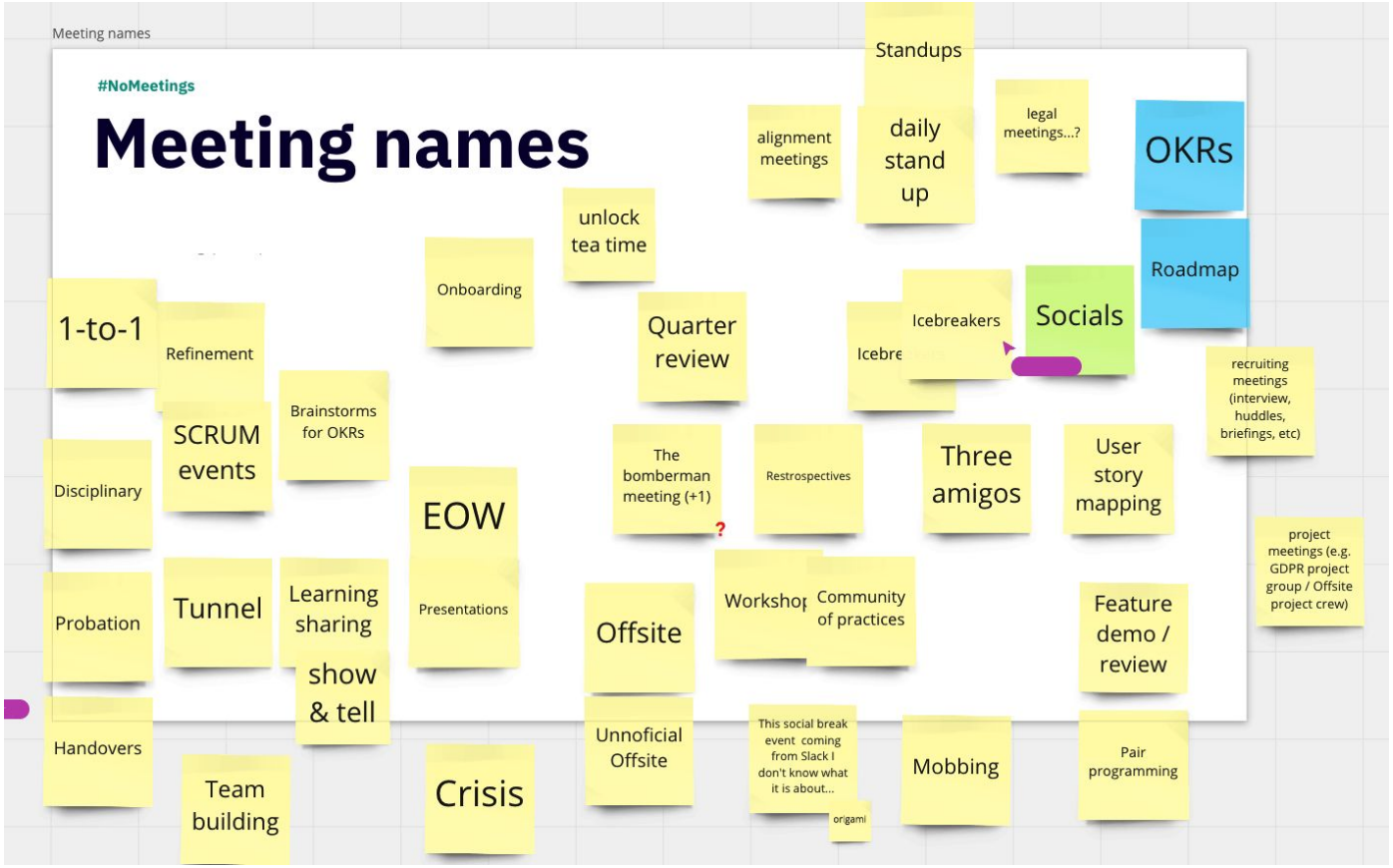
Why?

Organization's culture

Enablers



#NoMeetings


Meeting names
#NoMeetings
Meeting names
Standups
alignment meetings
daily stand up
legal meetings...?
OKRs
Roadmap
unlock tea time
Onboarding
1-to-1
Refinement
Quarter review
Icebreakers
Socials
recruiting meetings (interview, huddles, briefings, etc)
SCRUM events
Brainstorms for OKRs
Disciplinary
The bomberman meeting (+1)
Restrospectives
Three amigos
User story mapping
EOW
project meetings (e.g. GDPR project group / Offsite project crew)
Probation
Tunnel
Learning sharing
Presentations
Offsite
Community of practices
Feature demo / review
show & tell
Handovers
Unnoficial Offsite
This social break event coming from Slack I don't know what it is about...
Mobbing
Pair programming
Team building
Crisis
origami

Inventorize your meetings





Inventorize your meetings

Starts reflection
Helps seeing the whole
Systemic retrospectives
KPIs

Meeting types

Status update
Informative
Figuring things out / idea ripening
Decision-making
Learning
Collaborative work / co-creation
Social
Goal-driven

Meeting types

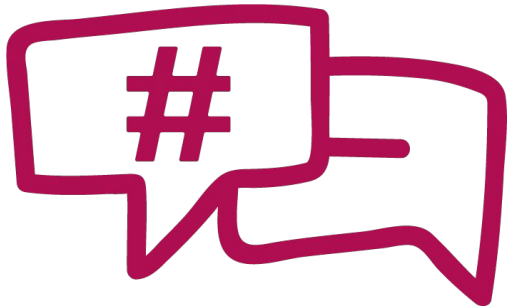
Status update
Informative
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Examples

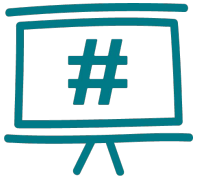
Daily, weekly
All-hands
Product Refinement
Strategy, product proposal
Trainings, capacity buildings
Pairing, mob programming
Offsites, team building, 1-to-1
Sales and Support calls

Discuss moving to async

Status update
Informative
Figuring things out / idea ripening
Decision-making
Learning
Collaborative work / co-creation
Social
Goal-driven



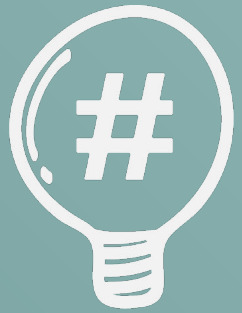
How we do it at Quaderno



Status update	Async-backed
Informative	Async
Figuring things out	Async + Sync
Decision-making	Async + In person offsites for strategy
Learning	Async-backed
Collaborative work	Async + Sync
Social	Sync + In person sync
Goal-driven	Async + Sync

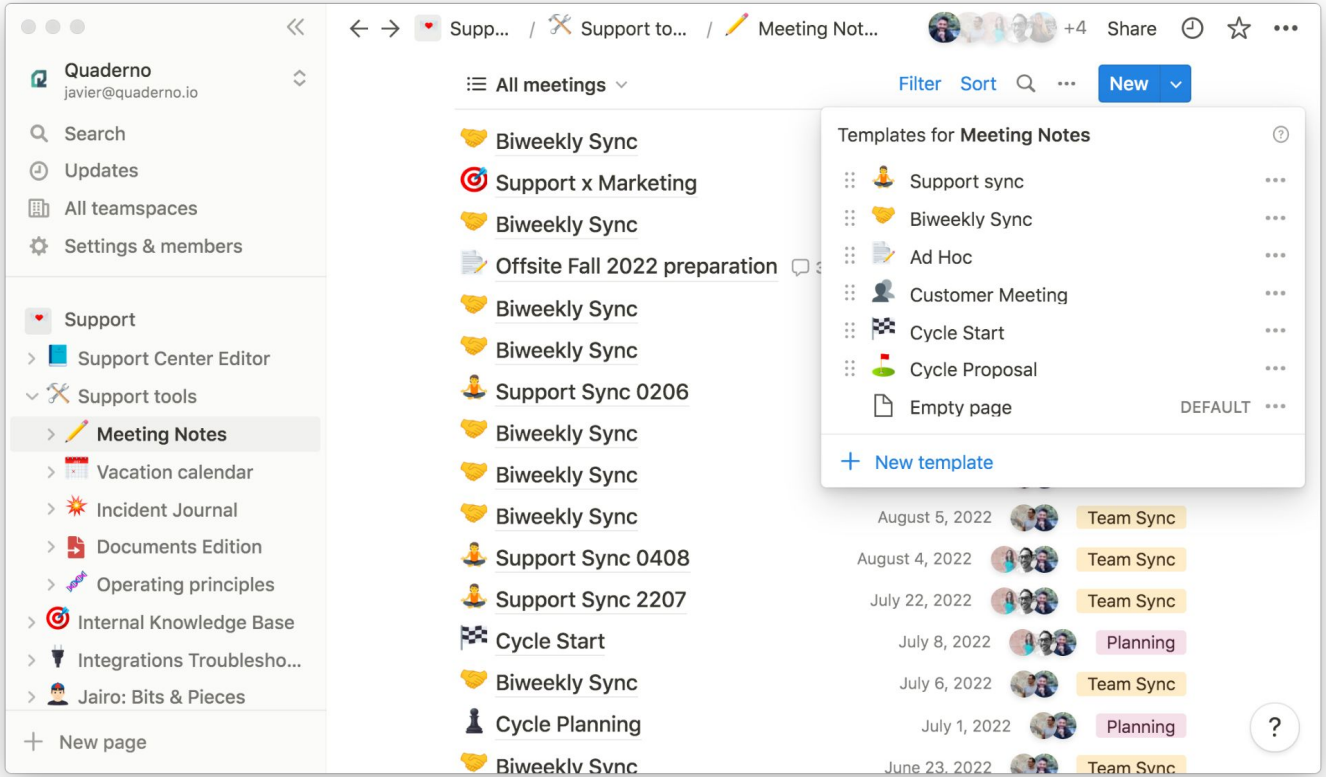
Introducing “async-backed”

Meeting notes sent 24h+ before
Everyone documents before and during
Sender facilitates



Content known in advance
Fastens the meeting
Many topics solved async, *before* the meeting

How we do it at Quaderno







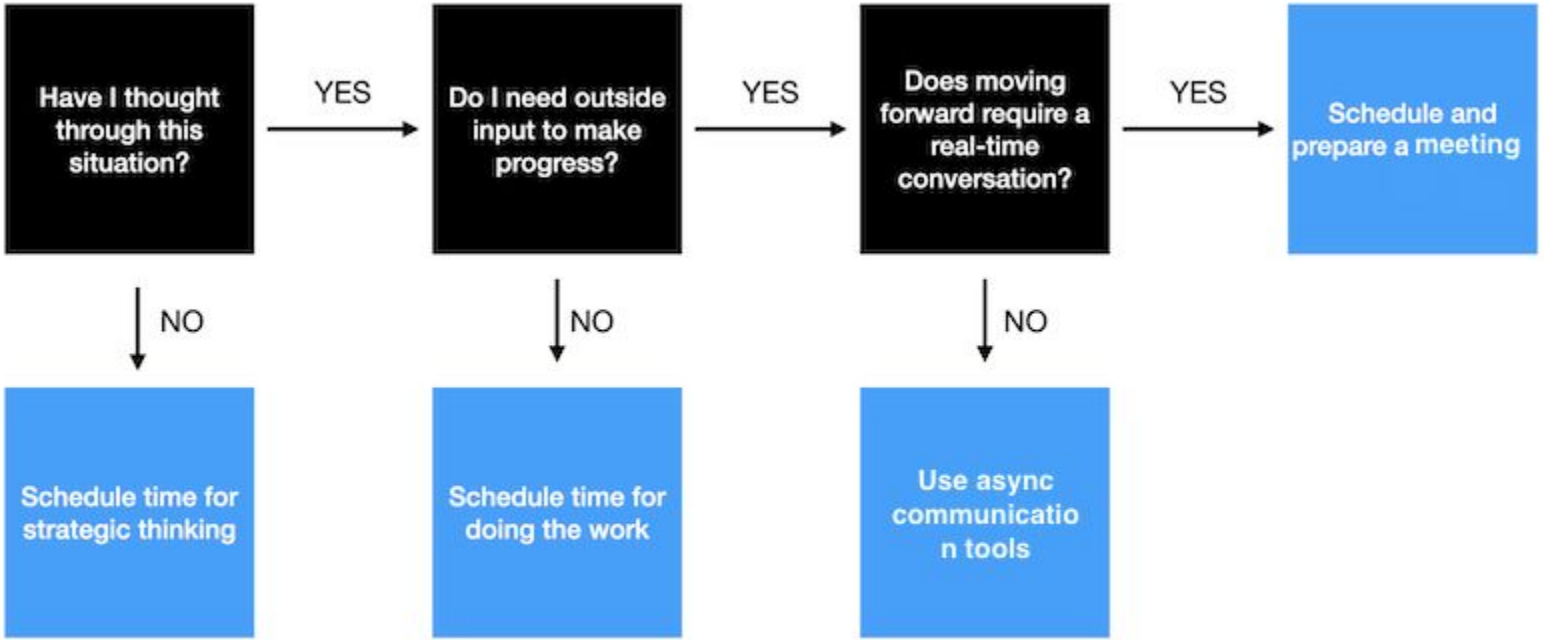
a day per week

looking for info

HALF THE TIME WE DON'T EVEN FIND IT

Knowledge Management is crucial

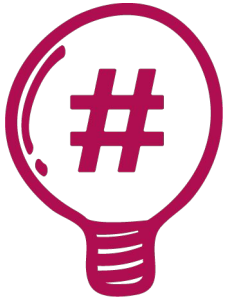
How we do it at Quaderno



"When to have a meeting" from quaderno.io internal handbook

Meeting types

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Informative
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Collaborative work
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Goal-driven



Goal-driven

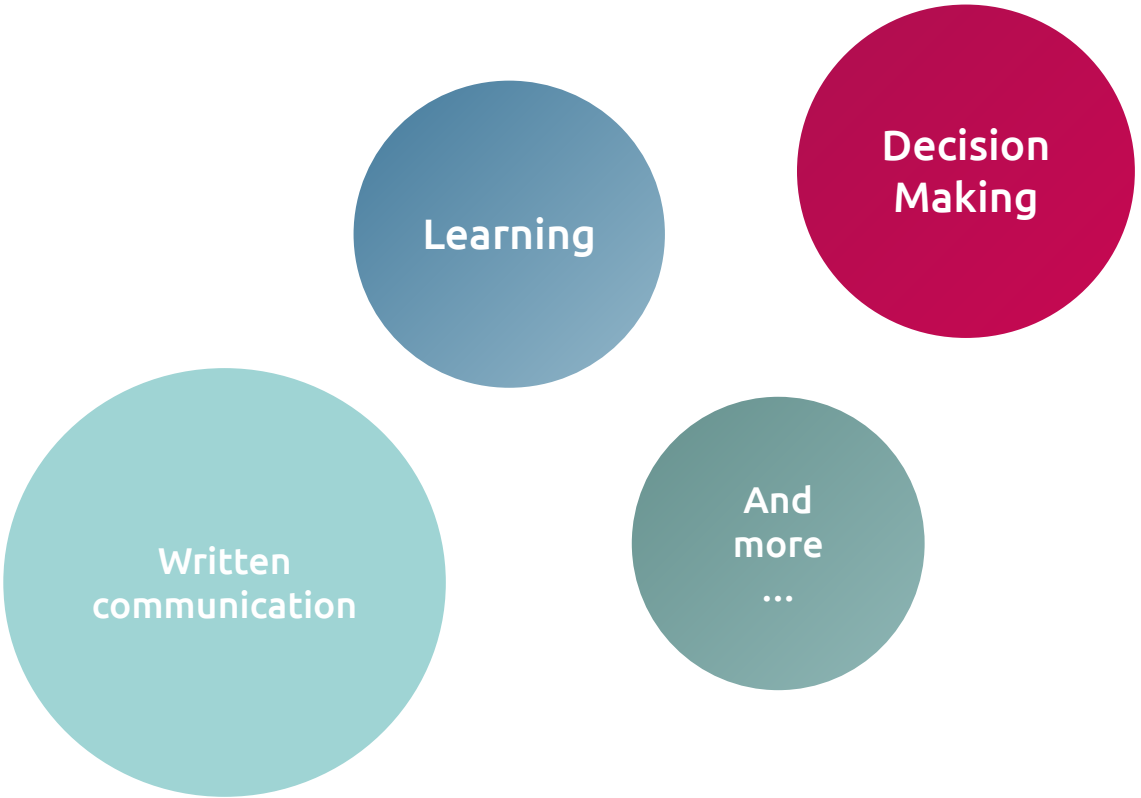
Sales and Support teams are the only ones who have received **formal training** to improve their meetings and related skills.

Collaboration skills

Different meetings require different skill sets. And **skills are trainable**!



Collaboration skills



Written communication

Allows for pause & reflect.
It's more inclusive.



Be concise
Start by practicing summarizing
Think of information structure

Decision making

Thinking traps and biases:

⇒ Groupthinking
⇒ Echo chamber
⇒ Loudest voice
⇒ Halo Effect
⇒ Recency bias

Decision making

Mindsets

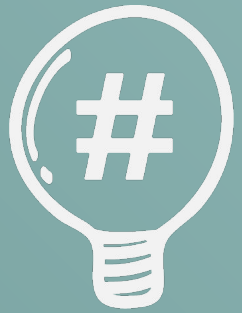
- Systems Thinking
- Theory of complexity

Tools

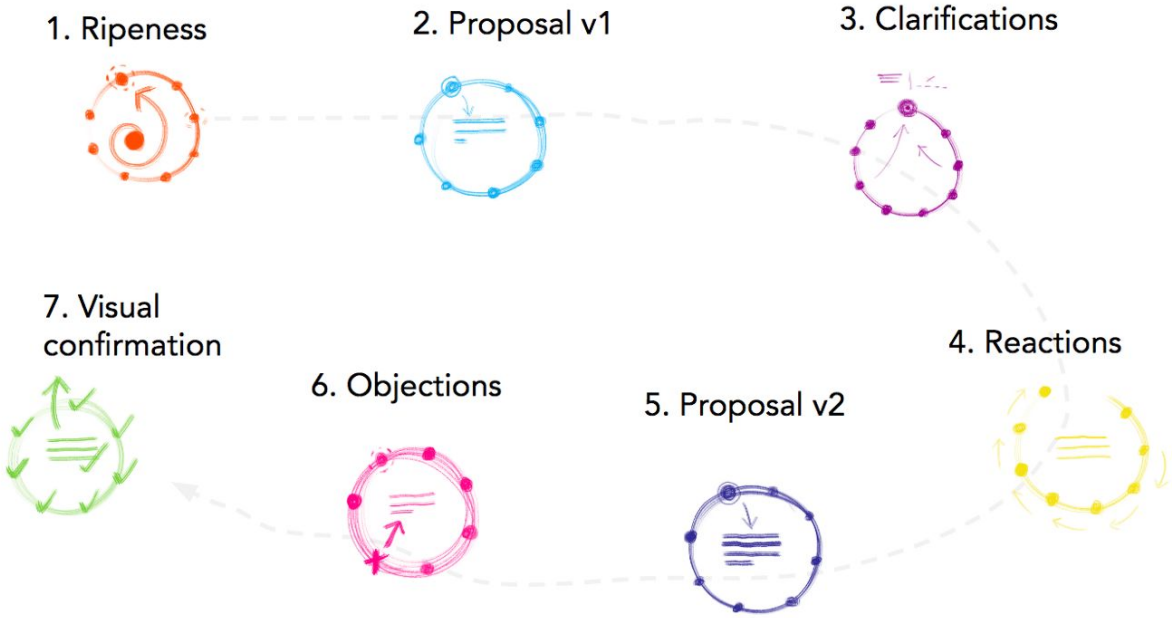
- CLD's (Causal Loop Diagrams)
- Cynefin framework

Shu Ha Ri

The martial arts path to mastery



Decision making



Generative decision process by Samantha Slade

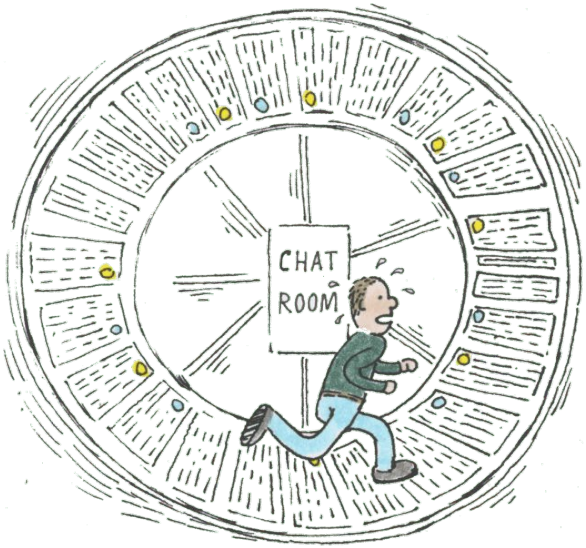
Learning

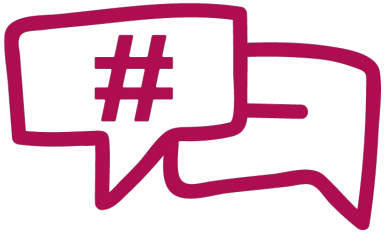


Most effective science-based learning strategies by www.learningscientists.org

Last but not least...

Live-chat: all-day meeting





Tweak noise vs. transparency

Working Agreements

Company-wide, per team, situational

Image credit: https://m.signalvnoise.com/is-group-chat-making-you-sweat/

Don’t let tools model your behaviour
Model your tools

nomeetings.work

Thanks

for your time!

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